

App Lock & Privacy

The three-secret lock, biometrics, and the privacy screens

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Flutter / Dart · Android



PIN



Swipe code



Tap rhythm



Biometrics

1. Why Three Secrets Instead of One PIN

App Lock is always **three** secrets set up together. Each time the app needs to check it's really you, it asks for just **one of the three, picked at random**.

Secret	What it is	Anti-snooping touch
PIN	Six digits on an on-screen keypad	The digit layout is reshuffled on every open and after every wrong try
Swipe code	A short sequence of up / down / left / right swipes	Each swipe is its own gesture, not a connect-the-dots pattern
Tap rhythm	Five taps whose gaps are each judged quick or slow	Cares about timing, not position, so it can't be read by watching where fingers land

Someone who glimpses a single unlock over your shoulder still can't reliably get in next time, because they'd need to have seen the same secret that happens to be requested again.

2. The Four Lock Screens

Screen	When it appears	What it asks
Set up	From Privacy Settings, first time	PIN, then Swipe Code, then Tap Rhythm — each entered twice and reviewed before being locked in
Everyday unlock	Every time the app opens, returns from the background, or after Log Out	One secret, chosen at random
Re-verify	Before changing the lock	All three secrets, one after another — a stricter bar for a higher-stakes moment

Screen	When it appears	What it asks
Forgot Password	From the unlock screen	A recovery check (see below)

3. Wrong Guesses

The same challenge stays up after a single mistake so a genuine typo can be retried. After **five wrong attempts in a row**, input stops and a countdown shows until a fresh attempt is allowed. If the app is closed mid-countdown, the countdown is still there when it is reopened.

4. Fingerprint / Face Unlock

- Offered as “Use biometrics instead” only when the phone has the hardware **and** at least one fingerprint or face enrolled.
- It is a faster door in, not a replacement. The real secrets remain fully required for anyone whose phone has no biometrics.
- The phone’s own system does all the scanning. DepoVaultTick never sees or stores any biometric data — it only receives a yes or no.
- A cancelled or failed scan does not count towards the five-attempt limit, because the phone enforces its own limit.
- It is deliberately **not** offered when changing the lock — that still needs all three real secrets.

5. Forgot Password

A recovery route exists for someone who has forgotten a secret. Instead of a fixed, guessable security question, it uses checks that only the genuine owner of the saved information could reasonably pass. After passing, the person chooses which secrets to set fresh — they don’t have to redo ones they still remember.

Recovery is treated as weaker proof

A successful recovery unlocks the app for this visit only and does **not** grant the normal “stays trusted for the session” status. Even opening the recovery screen — without finishing it — makes every section ask again next time.

6. Privacy Settings

Two boxes, each an independent lock:

Box	Secrets	Guards
App Lock	PIN + Swipe Code + Tap Rhythm	Home, and with it the whole app; also re-asked after Log Out and on return from the background

Box	Secrets	Guards
Stash Lock	PIN + Pattern	The Stash only — every time something sensitive happens there

- Both are **all-or-nothing** once set — there is no “turn it off”, and no “pick just one” option.
- Changing either requires proving the current secrets first.
- Both offer Forgot Password as a way past a forgotten secret.

7. About App

A swipeable deck of full-screen cards with a row of dots, in the style of a phone’s first-run tour. Nothing scrolls; each card fits the screen. Opened from the Home menu.

Card	Content
Overview	Name, logo, version (1.0.0, build 1) and a one-line summary of the five sections
Privacy & Safety	Plain rules: data stays on this device; the app is for the owner’s personal use; the lock is the only thing between a holder of the phone and the data, so keep it as private as a bank PIN; only an exported backup is separately encrypted
Five section cards	Family & Vault, Notes, Daily Log, Stash and Work — each explaining what it is for, what you see, and what you can do

8. An Honest Limit

What the lock does and doesn’t do

The App Lock and Stash Lock protect against someone who has your phone in their hand. They are not a substitute for the phone’s own screen lock, and anything exported leaves that protection behind — which is why backups carry their own password.